

James Vickers MCIM MCPR

Sheffield / Lincoln, UK - 1.5hrs from London - 07897714630 - james@manual-focus.co.uk

Senior marketing leader with ten years in CMO, Head of Marketing and senior PR/brand roles across cycling, endurance sport and fitness technology. Currently Marketing Consultant at Ribble Cycles and Fractional CMO at AI wealth-advisory platform chatwithmotif.com. Track record in brand repositioning, complex multi-channel campaigns, team leadership, PR and owned-media, paid performance, and embedding AI/ML across marketing, product and finance. Proven ability to scale subscription, D2C and brand-led businesses across the UK, Europe and globally.

KEY SKILLS & EXPERTISE

Marketing Strategy - Brand Strategy - Brand Creative Direction - Campaign Management - Content Strategy - GTM Strategy - Positioning & Messaging - **PR Strategy - Owned Media Strategy** - Media Relations - Press Office - Thought Leadership - **Paid Performance Marketing - SEO** - SEM / PPC - CRM & Lifecycle Email - eCommerce - Analytics & Attribution - Sponsorships & Partnerships - Ambassador & Influencer Marketing - Event Management - Pro Team Activation - Agency Management - Senior Marketing Leadership - Team Building - Business Development - Budget Ownership (£1.2M+) - Investor Relations - Funding - Board-Level Reporting - AI & Machine Learning - AI Agent Orchestration - Vibe Coding - Vibe Marketing - Organisational Automation - Claude Code

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

Ribble Cycles - High-Performance D2C Bike Brand Nov 2024 - Present

Marketing Consultant (currently 3 days/week advisory)

Budget responsibility: £1.2M. Landed 2024/2025 budget under at £920,000.

- Reshaped the marketing team - reorganised roles and responsibilities across the department.
- Built organisational structure - processes, planning, and a new task management platform.
- Day-to-day management of marketing team, retail stakeholders, and agencies.
- Onboarded Shift Active Media (PR) and Commute Films (creative video production).
- Board-level impact - strategic presentations to the board as part of the SMT to PE Owners.
- Built strategic PR process - managed product-to-journalist pipeline on schedule. Secured BBC and ITV TV coverage in 2025.
- Coverage growth - articles 135 to 196, est. views 1.89M to 4.42M, potential audience 117M to 327M.
- Brand repositioning - shifted perception from "budget heritage" to "high-performance technical" - ULTRA-RACE compared to Colnago rather than Planet X or Dolan.
- Ribble Outliers - thought leadership on LinkedIn alongside B2C content. Partnership marketing with Precision and Restrap added 8,000+ email subscribers.
- Presenting Partner, British Gravel Championships - digital and physical rights negotiation, planning, and execution.
- Gravel category growth - Ribble's fastest-growing segment, +2pp above market, taking competitor share.
- Ribble Outliers race programme - all four national titles at the 2026 UK Gravel National Championships, 2nd at the UCI Gralloch with Jenson Young, and a team film from The Traka in Girona, each turned into campaigns across owned and earned channels.
- The Original Outliers rebrand - worked with FreshBritain on repositioning tone of voice and visual language.
- 2025 strategic objectives - grow gravel market share, increase regional penetration (NE and South), launch four new bikes.
- Led NPD marketing - market gap analysis, sign-off documents, and GTM strategies.
- Smurfit Westrock & Cyclist magazine - "Welcome to Hell" mini-documentary on the CiCLE Classic win.

motif - AI-Powered Wealth Advisory (Fintech) 2024 - Present

Fractional CMO (ESOP Holder)

Originally an advisory board role. ESOP holder handling the full marketing mandate with a small team and budget. motif is being built using Claude Code - actively involved in product feature development.

- Full marketing ownership: brand and website development, hosting, updates, and social media management.
- Pivoted to B2B outreach, contacting 1,000+ fintech organisations to develop the sales pipeline.
- Generated a qualified "under-negotiation" phase of over £150M in assets under management across seven entities.
- Built a pipeline of approximately 30 prospects in varying stages.
- AI product development - actively involved in building features within the motif app using Claude Code.

Classified Cycling - Cycling Component Manufacturer Jun 2024 - Nov 2024

Head of Marketing and Communications

- Led the research, validation, and integration of brand and product positions.
- 160+ media placements - spearheaded global product launches, including the Vistar // Powershift drivetrain at Eurobike.
- Global events - managed Eurobike, Sea Otter, and Taichung Bike Week to strengthen partnerships and drive growth.
- AI/ML adoption - led adoption of AI and machine learning across departments.
- Team leadership - led the marketing team and agencies to deliver cohesive digital, PR, and social campaigns.
- Enhanced education and process for IBDs and distributors.

Muuvr - Swiss-Based Health & Wellbeing App Jan 2023 - May 2024

CMO

- Brand development - led Muuvr's brand and visual identity from scratch, including persona work.
- AI strategy - designed and implemented AI strategies across product, marketing, and financial decision-making.
- \$4.5M fundraise - contributed to a successful fundraising effort securing \$4.5M in investment.
- GTM execution - oversaw go-to-market strategy, procured and managed agencies across creative, performance, and PR.
- Gamification - led development of key gamification strategies driving user engagement.

Wahoo Fitness - Multi-faceted Indoor Training Platform Apr 2022 - Jan 2023

Head of Marketing (Subscription Services)

- Led strategic development and execution of Wahoo X's integrated marketing strategy.
- Directed go-to-market, PR, partnerships, product innovation, and multi-channel marketing.
- Managed global product launches and expanded RGT retail presence to 500+ retailers.
- Led the Wahoo X GTM Fall 2022 campaign, securing media coverage in 20 top publications.

RGT Cycling - Indoor Cycling Platform 2019 - 2022

Chief Marketing Officer (2021-2022) - Head of Brand & Marketing (2019-2021)

- Co-founded RGT Cycling. Drove register-to-ride conversions from 20% to 45% within 12 months.
- Grew subscribers from 0 to 10K and registered users from 100 to 450K. MOU/WAU increased ~3,000%.
- Directed content strategy generating over 2.2M sessions from ~1M users.
- Improved prompted brand recall from 2 to 95 and unprompted from 0 to 75.
- Defined GTM flywheel utilising partnerships with over 100 brands. Elevated NPS from -65 to +45.
- Played critical role in corporate strategy and due diligence during acquisition by Wahoo Fitness.

Wattbike - Indoor Training Bike 2018 - 2019

PR & Marketing Manager

- Media perception shift - shifted perceptions of the Wattbike Atom, improving mid-funnel retention and driving conversions.
- Global events - delivered growth through events across the UK, Europe, and Africa.
- Ambassador marketing - built the framework for selecting and engaging ambassadors and high-profile talent.

- International support - provided tailored marketing materials and training for distributors and dealers.

Pelotan - Cycling Specific Sun Protection 2018 - 2020

Consultant Marketing Director

Ribble - High-End D2C Bike Brand 2017 - 2018

Head of Brand & Marketing

Developed and executed brand and marketing strategies. Led digital efforts (SEO, performance, email). Directed content creation and oversaw influencer partnerships.

Planet X Bikes - D2C Bike Brand 2015 - 2017

Head of Sales and Marketing

Developed and executed sales and marketing strategies driving revenue growth. Led digital marketing, optimised eCommerce, and implemented customer segmentation. Built key supplier relationships.

ADDITIONAL

Professional Accreditations: MCIM - MCPR

Personal Interests: Gravel Racing - 9th (40-44), UK National Gravel Championships 2026 - Road Cycling - 15th at National Championships 2025 - XC MTB - Travel - Adventure Sports - Sustainability - Technology - AI

AI Exploration / Side Projects: Aster (2025, Founder) - real-time event tracking platform shipped to iOS and Android, built and operated solo with orchestrated AI agents. Wattplan (2025, Founder) - AI-powered endurance training app built end-to-end with Claude Code (wattplan.cc).

Industry Network: Extensive network in cycling built over almost 15 years. Deep relationships with journalists, brands, athletes, agencies, retailers, distributors, and event organisers across the UK and Europe.

Travel: 30% possible - UK, Europe.

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

MCIM - Marketing - MCPR - Public Relations

Higher Diploma - Fishing & Fishery Sciences & Management (Distinction)

ISEB - BCS Requirements Engineering - ISEB - BCS Certificate in Business Analysis

Information Technology Infrastructure Library (ITIL)